

mints, eyeglass repair kits, batteries, and pain relief medication entice the consumer to purchase just one more thing.

None of this is left to coincidence. When a business understands consumer behavior, they can design marketing plans to influence purchasing decisions. Consumers are at least marginally aware of this. They were wary of advertising as long ago as 1925, when crusading journalist Stuart Chase took direct aim at commercial advertising in his book *Tragedy of Waste* and two years later, at corporate manufacturers in *Your Money's Worth: A Study in the Waste of the Consumer's Dollars*. But it was Vance Packard's 1957 *The Hidden Persuaders* that really blew the lid off of corporate advertising and motivational research. According to the *Wiley International Encyclopedia of Marketing* (2010), questions such as "Why are ice cream containers round?" or "Where did the maternal Betty Crocker appearance come from?" are related to a form of consumer research called "motivation research," a term used to refer to research methods designed to probe consumer's minds to discover the deep, often subconscious reasons and goals underlying everyday consumer behaviors. Motivation research was the premier consumer research method used in the 1950s.

Sigmund Freud's psychoanalytic theories on deeply hidden needs and drives underlying all human behavior provided the foundation for the development of motivation research in marketing. Ernest Dichter, often referred to as the "father of motivational research," was a trained psychoanalyst in Vienna who moved to New York in 1938. The founder of The Institute for Motivational Research, he began applying psychoanalytical techniques to the study of consumer buying habits, using